

BOLIVIA

Bolivia – Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Plurinational State of Bolivia
Short Form	Bolivia
Capital	Sucre (constitutional), La Paz (seat of government and executive capital)
Region (UN)	Latin America and the Caribbean
Government Type	Unitary presidential republic with plurinational and multicultural character
Head of State	Luis Arce, President
Head of Government	Luis Arce, also serving as Head of Government
Currency	Boliviano (BOB)
UN Member Since	14 November 1945
MUN Standing	Strong voice on indigenous rights, anti-imperialism, environmental protection, and sovereignty. Frequently emphasizes Global South solidarity in international forums.

Recommended Books on Bolivia's Foreign Policy & UN Engagement

Title	Author(s)	Why It's Relevant
<i>Bolivia in the Age of Gas</i>	Bret Gustafson	Examines Bolivia's resource nationalism and global engagement, including at the UN.
<i>The Bolivia Reader: History, Culture, Politics</i>	Sinclair Thomson et al.	Offers essential historical and cultural context to understand Bolivia's UN positions.
<i>Rethinking Latin America: Development, Hegemony, and Social Transformation</i>	Ronaldo Munck	Contextualizes Bolivia's political ideology and development policy in international arenas.
<i>Plurinational Democracy: Decolonizing the State in Latin America</i>	Catherine Walsh	Explores Bolivia's indigenous approach to governance, reflected in its UN narratives.
<i>Foreign Policy in Post-Coup Bolivia</i>	Thomas C. Field Jr.	Looks into how Bolivia's international strategy evolved post-2006, with UN implications.

Research Table: Bolivia & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Bolivia Human Rights Ministry	https://www.justicia.gob.bo/	Core agency responsible for coordinating with the UNHRC.
UNHRC – Bolivia Country Page	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/bolivia	Human rights documents, missions, and resolutions.
Universal Periodic Review – Bolivia	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/bo-index	Details Bolivia's recent reviews and accepted recommendations.
UN Web TV – Bolivia HRC Interventions	https://webtv.un.org	Use to locate live or archived sessions featuring Bolivia.
Amnesty International – Bolivia Reports	https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/americas/south-america/bolivia/	Annual reviews with documentation cited in HRC discussions.
Human Rights Watch – Bolivia Analysis	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/bolivia	Global watchdog evaluation of rights and governance in Bolivia.
OHCHR – Bolivia Country Visit Reports	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/bolivia	Special rapporteurs' evaluations of human rights conditions.

Bolivia's Role in Regional Indigenous Rights	https://www.oas.org/en/iachr/	Includes Bolivia's engagement in rights of indigenous peoples—key in UNHRC.
CEDIB (Documentation and Information Centre – Bolivia)	https://cedib.org	Critical reports on rights, surveillance, and police abuse.
Bolivia and Transitional Justice – HRW Archive	https://www.hrw.org	Discusses post-dictatorship accountability in Bolivia.

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OHCHR – Bolivia Country Profile	https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/bolivia (unodc.org, ohchr.org)	Official overview of treaty ratifications, OHCHR's work on ongoing national rights efforts.
OHCHR – Bolivia UPR Index & Docs	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/bo-index	Portal for UPR national reports, stakeholder inputs, and state responses.
HRW – UPR Submission (2014 PDF)	https://www.hrw.org/sites/default/files/related_material/HRW%20UPR%20Submission%20Bolivia%20-%20Updated%20in%20September%202014.pdf	NGO critique covering prison conditions, freedom of expression, and justice reform.
Amnesty – UPR Submission (2014 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.org/es/wp-content/uploads/2021/07/amr180022009eng.pdf	Highlights rights to free assembly, indigenous consent, and anti-torture standards.
Amnesty – UPR Submission (2019 PDF)	https://www.amnesty.be/IMG/pdf/amr1804852019english-3.pdf	Focused submission on defenders, gender and indigenous rights ahead of UPR cycle.
UPR Adoption Video – 48th Session	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1n/k1nu5k790z	Visual record of Bolivia's mid-2025 UPR dialogue—includes state-interactive Q&A.
UPR Adoption Video – 34th Session	https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k16/k16euwix9t	Historic session showing openness and evolution in Bolivia's UPR reporting.

OHCHR – Bolivia Stakeholder Documents (3rd Cycle)	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/bo-web-archives3rd-cycle	Archived civil society, UN, and NHRI submissions reflecting diverse perspectives.
State Dept – 2023 HR Report	https://www.state.gov/reports/2023-country-reports-on-human-rights-practices/bolivia/528267_bolivia-2023-human-rights-report/	US government overview on key concerns: protest response, judicial bias, prison conditions.
HRW – World Report 2023	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2023/country-chapters/bolivia	Covers rights defenders, political interference, and justice sector regression.
HRW – World Report 2024	https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/bolivia	Highlights 2019 abuses, ongoing lack of accountability, and use of terrorism laws.
Freedom House – Profile 2023	https://freedomhouse.org/country/bolivia/freedom-world/2023	Independent ratings of civic and political freedom, useful for UNHRC trends.
IACHR – 2024 Human Rights Report	https://www.oas.org/en/iachr/media_center/preleases/2024/053.asp	Regional body report on violence, discrimination, and indigenous rights in 2023.
Front Line Defenders – HR Defenders Monitor	https://www.frontlinedefenders.org/en/location/bolivia	Alerts on threats to activists, showing civil society pressure points.
Bolivia UPR Reference Docs – OHCHR	https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprbo-add-info-s7	State-submitted information supplementing compiled UPR data.

10 Unique Aspects: Bolivia & UNHRC

1. **Dual UPR Engagement:** Bolivia's ongoing mid-cycle UPR reports and the varied input from stakeholders highlight a robust interaction with the UNHRC.

2. **Prison Conditions Under Scrutiny:** HRW has raised alarms about the severe overcrowding and violence happening in Palmasola prison, which is a key focus for the UNHRC's detention agenda.
 3. **Broad Indigenous Rights Dialogue:** The UPR inputs highlight the importance of the right to self-determination and Free, Prior, and Informed Consent (FPIC), particularly when it comes to hydrocarbons and land use.
 4. **Human Rights Defender Pressure:** Front Line Defenders has highlighted ongoing threats, particularly focusing on Bolivia at the HRC defender protection table.
 5. **Use of 'Terrorism' Laws for Dissidents:** Human Rights Watch is raising alarms about how unclear anti-terror laws are stifling the right to protest. They're urging the UN Human Rights Council to take a closer look at the legal implications.
 6. **Consistent Judicial Interference Reporting:** HRW World Reports highlight politicization of courts—relevant to UN rule-of-law critiques.
 7. **US Rights Assessment Confirmation:** The State Department's reports align closely with the priorities set by the UN Human Rights Council, focusing on accountability, protests, and issues surrounding prisons.
 8. **Active Regional Human Rights Oversight:** The IACHR's site visit and the upcoming 2024 report are ramping up regional pressure and providing solid evidence for the UNHRC reviews.
 9. **Civil Society Engagement in UPR:** Stakeholder submissions and archived documents highlight the crucial role that NGOs play in ensuring the legitimacy of the UN.
 10. **Moderate Freedom & Civic Action:** Even with its limitations, Freedom House provides Bolivia with mixed freedom ratings, which can be quite useful for the UN when it comes to comparative benchmarking.
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